

Week 6 Lit Example Worksheet

JULIUS CAESAR: VALID FORM, UNPROVED PREMISE

Purpose: Apply Week 6's Whately method to Julius Caesar. Run the form test and the fact test separately before diagnosing soundness.

Directions: Use the Lit Example Reader. Do not collapse validity, truth, and persuasion into one answer.

Part 1: Form Test

Part 1 Q1: Reconstruct Brutus's argument in this form: All M are P; All S are M; therefore All S are P. Name M, S, and P.

Part 1 Q1 ANSWER BOX

Part 1 Q2: Apply the form test only. If Brutus's two premises were true, would the conclusion follow? Explain.

Part 1 Q2 ANSWER BOX

Part 2: Fact Test

Part 2 Q1: Which premise in Brutus's argument most needs factual proof? Explain why it is the pressure-point premise.

Part 2 Q1 ANSWER BOX

Part 2 Q2: What evidence would Brutus need in order to make that premise strong enough for a careful listener?

Part 2 Q2 ANSWER BOX

Part 3: Antony's Evidence

Part 3 Q1: List Antony's three main pieces of evidence against Brutus's ambition premise.

Part 3 Q1 ANSWER BOX

Part 3 Q2: Does Antony prove that Caesar was not ambitious, or does he mainly make Brutus's premise doubtful? Explain the difference.

Part 3 Q2 ANSWER BOX

Part 4: Final Diagnosis

Part 4 Q1: Diagnose Brutus's argument as valid, invalid, sound, unsound, or not yet proved. You may use more than one label if you explain the difference.

Part 4 Q1 ANSWER BOX

Part 4 Q2: In one paragraph, explain why "valid" does not mean "true" using Brutus and Antony as your example.

Part 4 Q2 ANSWER BOX